unhinge the defences, but the Pakistani forces held on until 14 December, when 8 Mountain Division captured the city.

Operating on the Agartala–Akhaura–Ashuganj–Dacca axis, 57 Mountain Division took Akhaura on 5 December and by 7 December Brahmanbaria had also been captured. The operation stalled somewhat at Ashuganj, with the Meghna bridges being blown up by the enemy. At this point, Lieutenant General Sagat Singh, GOC IV Corps, decided to use Mil Mi-4 helicopters to ferry troops across the Meghna. The IAF carried out 110 sorties over the next 36 hours carrying troops to Raipura, while 73 Mountain Brigade crossed the Meghna on boats and riverine craft.